

Derbyshire Shared Care Pathology Guidelines

Haematuria

Definitions

Haematuria is the presence of abnormal numbers of red blood cells in the urine.

- Non-visible (previously known as microscopic) haematuria is detected on a urine dipstick and is a common incidental finding
- Non-visible haematuria should be considered as persistent if 2 out of 3 dipsticks are positive (haematuria 1+ or higher) in the absence of proteinuria (NICE NG203)
- There is no need to use urine microscopy to confirm a positive urine dipstick for haematuria (1+ or higher) (NICE NG203)
- Visible (previously known as macroscopic or frank) haematuria is visible to the eye

Painless visible haematuria is a significant symptom and should be investigated in all cases unless a definite cause for the bleeding is known

Causes of haematuria

Bleeding can originate from anywhere along the urinary tract.

Transient

- Trauma
- Exercise induced

Malignant

- Prostate cancer, renal cell carcinoma, urothelial cancer, penile cancer, gynaecological cancers

Infection/Inflammation

- UTI
- Urethritis

Renal disease

- Glomerular bleeding (including IgA nephropathy, Alport's disease and thin basement membrane disease)
- Structural disease (e.g. Polycystic kidney disease, medullary sponge kidney)

Obstructive

- Urolithiasis
- BPH

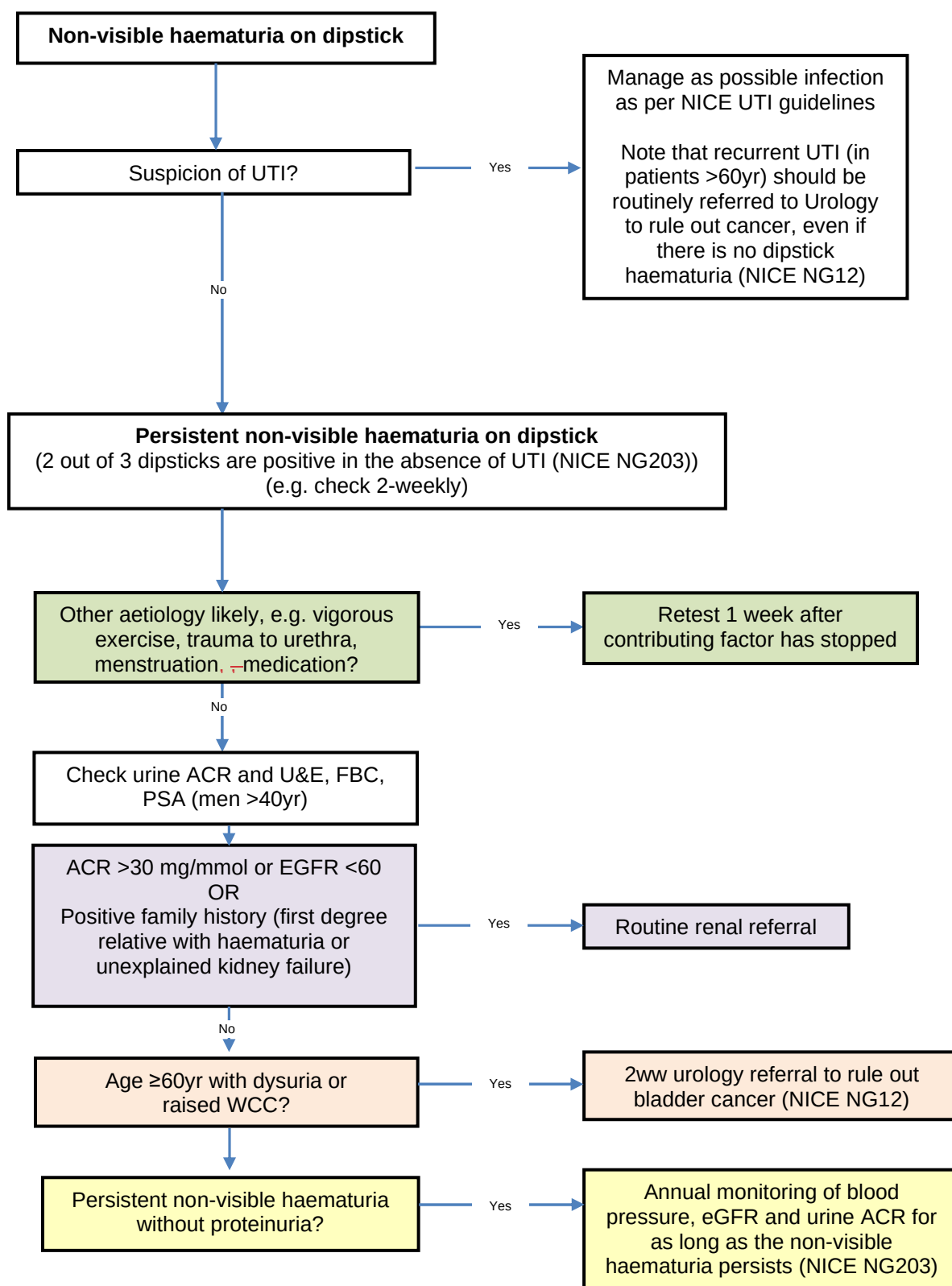
Other causes of red urine include:

Haemoglobinuria secondary to rhabdomyolysis or haemolysis

Porphyria

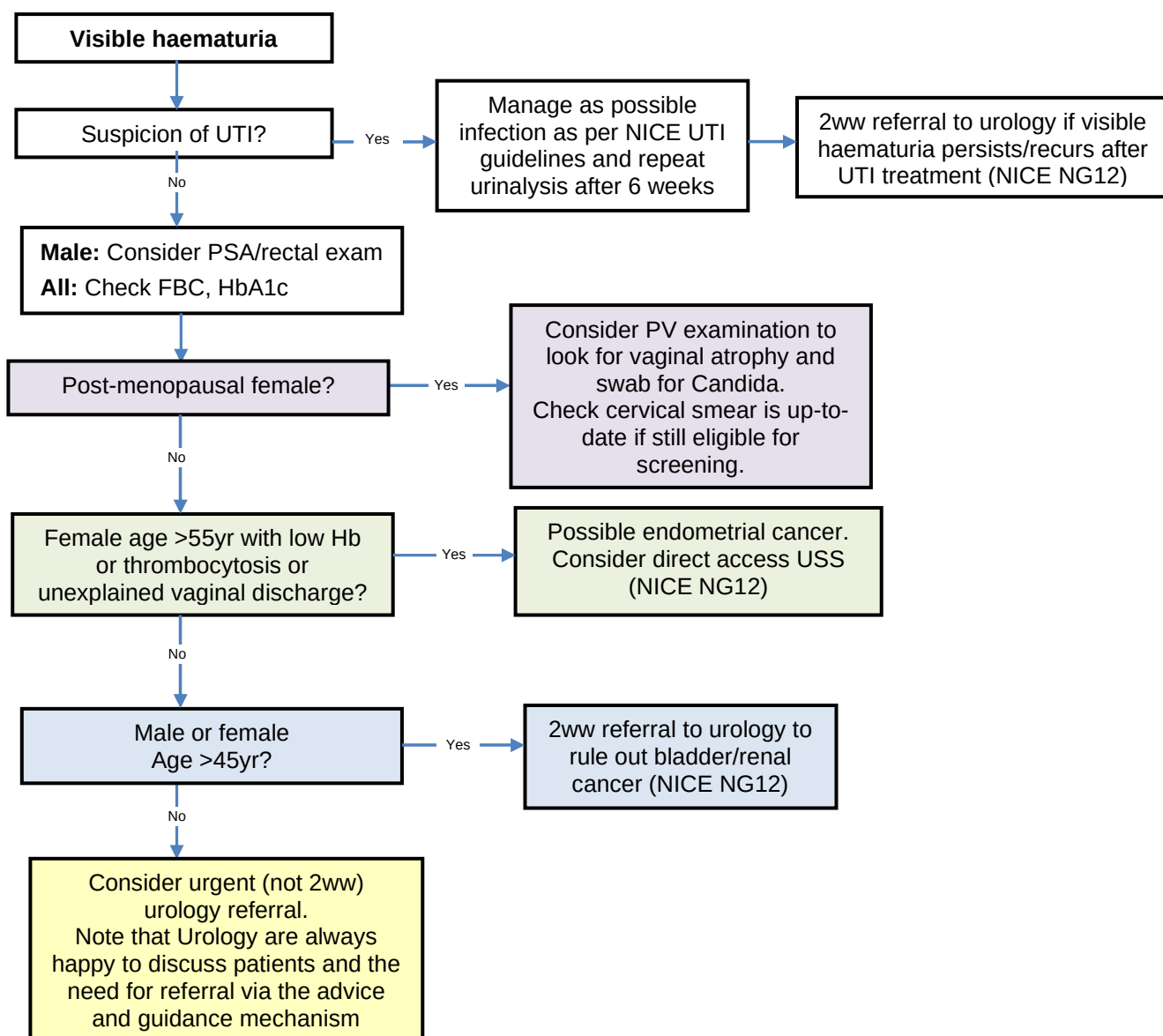
Medications / foods / toxins – e.g. rifampicin, beets, lead poisoning

Non-visible haematuria



Visible haematuria

Cancer is a possible diagnosis in patients with visible haematuria. It requires severe cystitis to be due to infection and is only rarely due to nephritis such as IgA nephropathy or post-infection glomerulonephritis.



References

Suspected cancer: Recognition and referral. NICE guideline NG12, last updated Dec 21. <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng12>

Chronic kidney disease: assessment and management. NICE guideline NG203, last updated Nov 21. <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng203>

Document title	Haematuria		
Revision	2	Document Reference	CHISCP62
Reason for Review	Routine Review		
Review history	Version/Date	Authors	Reason for review
	V1 August 2023	Mr Simon Williams, Prof Nick Selby, Dr Penny Blackwell, Ms Helen Seddon	New Document
Approval	Date	Name(s)	Designation
Secondary Care UHDB	05.08.25	Mr S Williams	Consultant Urologist
	07.08.25	Prof N Selby	Consultant Nephrologist
Secondary Care CRH	05.08.25	Ms K Linton	Consultant Urologist
Primary Care	07.08.25	Dr P Blackwell	GP
Laboratory (Derbyshire Pathology)	07.08.25	Ms S Knowles	Consultant Clinical Scientist